

GROUNDWORK STUDIO

Cold Calling Sales Guide

Scripts · Discovery · Pipeline · Objection Handling · Q&A

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SECTION 1

The Mindset

Cold calling is not about selling a website on the first call. It's about opening a conversation with a business owner who doesn't know you exist yet. Your only job on call #1 is to get them curious enough to look at a demo.

Three rules before you dial:

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. You are solving a real problem. | Most local businesses leave money on the table because their online presence is weak or nonexistent. You are not bothering them — you are offering a solution. |
| 2. Every no is just missing information. | They said no because they don't have enough context. Your job is to figure out what's missing and fill that gap. |
| 3. The demo does the selling. | You don't need to close on the call. Get them to a demo link. The work speaks for itself. |

SECTION 2

The Scripts

Cold Open (No Website)

Use when the business has no website or a very outdated one.

"Hi, is this [Name]? Hey — this is Evan calling from Groundwork Studio. We build websites for [industry] businesses here in Phoenix. I actually pulled up your business online and noticed you don't have a website set up yet — is that something you've thought about? ... [pause] ... Yeah totally — I'd love to just shoot you a quick link to a demo site I built for another [industry] company. Takes about 30 seconds to look at. What's the best email to send it to?"

Cold Open (Has a Website)

Use when the business has a site but it looks dated or underperforming.

"Hi [Name], this is Evan with Groundwork Studio — we build custom websites for service businesses in Phoenix. I checked out your site and I think we could make it a lot more effective for you — like getting more calls coming in from Google. I'm not trying to do a big pitch — I just want to send you a quick demo so you can see the difference. What's a good email?"

The Voicemail

"Hey [Name], this is Evan from Groundwork Studio — we build websites for [industry] businesses in Phoenix. I was going to send you a quick demo but wanted to make sure I had

the right contact first. Give me a call back at (480) 452-6473, or I'll try you again in a couple days. Thanks."

The Follow-Up (2nd Contact)

"Hey [Name], Evan from Groundwork Studio again – I sent over a demo site a few days ago, just wanted to make sure you had a chance to see it. I know it's busy – even just 30 seconds on it would be worth your time. Happy to jump on a quick call if you have questions. You can reach me at (480) 452-6473."

SECTION 3

Finding the Problem

Don't ask 'do you have any problems?' — they'll say no. Use indirect, assumptive questions that make problems feel normal. Once they acknowledge a gap, the demo sells itself.

The Opening Hook

After your intro — before pitching anything:

"I work with a lot of [restaurants / contractors / salons] in [city] — most of them tell me the same thing: their website either doesn't exist, hasn't been touched in years, or just isn't bringing in any new customers. Is that something you're running into at all?"

This normalizes the problem so they don't feel embarrassed, and gives them a soft yes/no that leads naturally into a real conversation.

Discovery Questions

Use 1-2 of these — don't rapid-fire them all. Listen after each one. Silence is good.

"When someone searches for [your type of business] in [city], do you know where you're showing up?"	Makes them realize they don't actually know — opens the SEO conversation naturally.
"How are most of your new customers finding you right now?"	Exposes referral dependency. If they say 'word of mouth,' you have your angle.
"If someone Googled you right now, what would they find?"	Direct and honest. A pause or laugh tells you everything.
"Do you have a way to collect reviews from happy customers, or is that kind of hit or miss?"	Surfaces a specific, fixable gap — especially powerful for trades and services.
"Has anyone come in recently and said they found you online?"	If they pause or laugh, that's your signal. Low online traffic confirmed.
"What does your current site do for you — do people actually call from it?"	Gets them to evaluate their own asset critically. Most will admit it underperforms.

Common Pain Points to Listen For

Businesses with weak or no online presence almost always share one or more of these problems:

Pain Point	What's Actually Happening
Invisible to Google	No GMB listing, outdated info, zero local SEO — competitors with worse service rank above them.
Referral dependency	90%+ of customers come from word of mouth — fine until it slows down, then they're stuck.
Dead or no reviews	Last Google review is years old. First impression is a ghost town — customers bounce.
Website embarrassment	They have one, but it's so outdated they don't give out the URL. It's worse than nothing.
Missing mobile customers	Their site breaks on phones — 70%+ of local searches happen on mobile devices.
No after-hours capture	Someone searches at 9pm, finds nothing, calls a competitor who has a contact form.
Losing the comparison	When a prospect compares two businesses, clean site + good reviews wins by default.
Lost trust signal	No website = not legit in the customer's mind — even if the work is excellent.

The Closing Bridge

Use this once they've confirmed any pain point:

"That's exactly what we help with — we build clean, professional sites that are set up to actually show up on Google in [city]. Most clients start seeing the difference within the first month. Got 15 minutes this week to walk through what that could look like for you?"

Short. Specific. Low-commitment ask. If they say yes to 15 minutes, you've moved them from CONTACTED to IN CONVERSATION.

SECTION 4

Pipeline View

Track every prospect through these stages. One row per lead.

Stage	Definition	Your Action	Move Forward When...
PROSPECT	Found the lead, not yet contacted	Research: do they have a site? What industry? Find a name.	You have a name and phone number.
CONTACTED	Left voicemail or spoke briefly	Log call date. Schedule follow-up in 2-3 days.	They expressed any interest or asked a question.
INTERESTED	Engaged in conversation, wants to know more	Send the most relevant demo link. Confirm email received.	They opened/clicked the demo or responded.
DEMO SENT	Demo link has been sent	Follow up 2 days later. Ask: 'Did you get a chance to check it out?'	They want to talk pricing or next steps.
IN CONVERSATION	Active back-and-forth happening	Answer questions. Send tier options. Keep momentum.	They ask 'how do we move forward?' or agree to a proposal.
CLOSED / WON	Deposit received, contract signed	Send contract + invoice. Begin intake process.	—
CLOSED / LOST	Said no or gone dark	Note the reason. Re-queue in 60 days.	—

Turning No's Into Yes's

Every objection is a request for more information. Don't argue — agree, empathize, then redirect.

"We already have a website."	"Totally — is it currently getting you new customers? ... A lot of businesses have a site but it's not actually working for them. I'd love to show you what a site built specifically to convert looks like. Can I send you a demo?"
"We can't afford it right now."	"I hear that a lot — what does your timeline look like for the year? ... The build fee is one-time — no surprise platform costs. There's a small monthly maintenance fee that covers hosting, security, and any updates, but that's it. We also split the build into two payments so it doesn't hit all at once. What would a realistic number look like for you?"
"I'm not interested."	"Fair enough — can I ask what's holding you back? Is it timing, budget, or you're just not thinking about a website right now? ... [if timing] When would be a better time to circle back?"
"Call me back later."	"Of course — what day works? I'll put it in my calendar right now. ... [confirm day/time and name] Perfect, I'll call you [day] at [time]. I'll shoot you a quick text so you have my number."
"We handle our marketing in-house."	"Smart — does that include the website too? I only ask because a lot of in-house teams prefer to outsource the development side to keep things clean. We build it, you own it, your team manages the content."
"How do I know you're legit?"	"Great question — we're a registered LLC in Arizona, and I can send you our business registration, contract, and a few demo sites right now. Everything's documented. Want me to shoot that over?"
"We use [Wix / Squarespace / GoDaddy]."	"Those are great for getting something up fast. The difference with us is we hand-code everything — no templates, no platform lock-in, no \$30/month fees. Your site is faster, unique, and you own it outright. Can I send you a quick comparison?"

Answering Specific Questions

These are the questions prospects ask most. Know these cold — you should be able to answer without thinking.

Q: How do you build these sites?

A: We hand-code everything from scratch — no Wix, no WordPress, no templates. Every site is written in clean HTML, CSS, and JavaScript specifically for that business. That means it loads faster, looks completely unique, and you're not paying \$30-40 a month to some platform forever. You own the site outright once it's paid off.

Q: Who hosts it?

A: We host it on a professional platform called Netlify — it's what major tech companies use. It's included in your monthly retainer. If you ever want to move it somewhere else, we can do that too for a small one-time migration fee.

Q: What's the monthly fee for?

A: The retainer covers hosting, security, any content updates you send us, and having someone to call when something needs to change. Every 90 days you also get a Quarterly Performance Report — we send you your Google traffic data, search impressions, GBP views, a summary of everything we did that quarter, and our top 1-2 recommendations. You're not just paying for the site to stay online — you're paying for full visibility into how it's actually performing.

Q: What if I want to cancel?

A: No problem — 30 days written notice and you're done. If you want to keep the site, we migrate it to your own hosting for a one-time fee. Nothing gets deleted without your say-so.

Q: How long does it take?

A: Most sites are live within 2-3 weeks from when we receive your content. The biggest delay is usually getting photos and text from the client — the build itself is fast.

Q: Can I see examples?

A: Absolutely — I'll send you the demo most relevant to your industry. We have sites built for HVAC, plumbing, landscaping, pest control, electrical, cleaning, pool service, painting, and more. Which one fits your business closest?

Q: Do you do SEO?

A: Every site we build is SEO-ready out of the box — proper meta tags, fast load times, mobile-first design, and Google-readable structure. That gives you a stronger foundation than most agencies start with. We also offer a one-time Local SEO Setup add-on for \$250. That covers Google Business Profile setup and optimization, schema markup so Google knows exactly what your business is, citation submissions to Yelp, BBB, and Apple Maps, and a keyword research doc for your top 5 search terms. Done once, no monthly fees. Most clients add it on — it's the fastest way to start showing up locally.

Q: What's your LLC or business registration?

A: We're registered as Groundwork Studio AZ LLC in the state of Arizona. I can send you our business registration, a signed contract template, and references from current clients. Whatever you need to feel comfortable.

Quick Reference

First call goal:	Get them to accept a demo link or give their email
Second contact:	2-3 days after first call
Demo follow-up:	2 days after sending the link
Voicemail rule:	Max 2 voicemails — then email
Never say:	"I'm just calling to check in" — always have a purpose
Always end with:	A specific next action (email, callback day, demo link)
Answer to any tech Q:	"We hand-code it from scratch — no templates, no platform fees"
Local SEO add-on:	\$250 one-time — GBP setup, schema markup, citations, keyword doc
Quarterly report:	Every 90 days — traffic, search impressions, GBP views, changes made, recommendations
LLC name on contract:	Groundwork Studio AZ LLC
Contact:	evan@teamground.work · (480) 452-6473 · teamground.work